LITTLE WONDERS ESL

Chemistry Word Lab: Acids and bases

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · sour, slippery and the pH scale



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. I taste sour. Lemon juice and vinegar are examples of me.
2. I am a chemical with a pH above 7. Soap and baking soda are examples of me.
3. My pH is exactly 7. Pure water is an example of me.

2 COOL FACT: THE PH SCALE

Acids and **bases** are two groups of chemicals. Lemon juice and vinegar are acids, and they taste **sour**. Soap and baking soda are bases. Bases feel slippery and taste **bitter**. We measure how strong they are with the **pH scale**, from 0 to 14. Acids have a pH below 7. Bases have a pH above 7. Pure water is **neutral**, with a pH of exactly 7. Never taste unknown chemicals in a laboratory.

sour = a sharp taste, like a lemon

bitter = a strong, unpleasant taste

slippery = smooth and difficult to hold

chemicals = substances used in chemistry

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

K	E	E	A	I	N	A	L	E	G	N	B
N	D	M	A	S	E	I	E	S	L	N	D
I	W	Q	E	O	U	X	M	A	R	S	S
R	G	B	R	A	T	J	O	C	E	O	S
O	A	G	D	P	R	C	N	I	H	H	C
V	I	N	E	G	A	R	N	D	S	N	A
B	A	S	E	N	L	S	E	P	A	F	L
S	A	A	S	O	U	R	L	S	S	R	E

WORD BANK

- ☐ **acid**
- ☐ **base**
- ☐ **neutral**
- ☐ **lemon**
- ☐ **vinegar**
- ☐ **soap**
- ☐ **sour**
- ☐ **scale**

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. Can you name an acid?
2. What is the pH of pure water?
3. Why should you never taste chemicals in a laboratory?